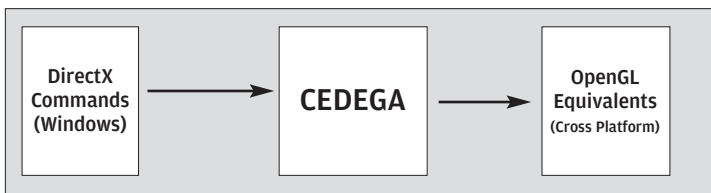


Need for Speed or *FIFA* on Linux? Then the equation would really be complete, right? This has already been thought of, and out of several attempts, a Linux application called Cedega has emerged—a blessing indeed for all game fans using Linux.

Cedega, made by a Canadian company called TransGaming, is a Linux portability product that allows Windows games to run on Linux seamlessly and transparently. (A portability product is an application or software that acts as an interface between two mis-matching products and makes them work with each other). Cedega simply fools the game into thinking that it is running on Windows. You can simply insert your Windows game CD, install and play the game just as you would on a Windows system. TransGaming claims that Cedega can run hundreds of top-tier titles such as *BattleField 2*, *World of WarCraft*, *Dungeon Siege 2*, *Madden 2006*, *Half-life 2*, *City of Villains*, *WarCraft III* and *Star Wars Galaxies*, and more.

How Cedega Works

Cedega loads a Windows program into memory on a Linux system and links it to a Linux equivalent of the Win32 APIs. Windows games use several multimedia APIs such as Direct3D, DirectInput, and DirectSound, which are part of Microsoft's DirectX. Cedega maps them to (or converts them to the equivalent of) Linux equivalents such as OpenGL, X11, and the OSS or ALSA sound APIs.



Thus, DirectX commands are converted to the OpenGL equivalents. Remember, DirectX API sets are used by virtually every game maker.